



The exchange involves no financial transaction between the guest and the host: you offer your home and stay in someone else's



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penetration will work as a catalyst for increasing HomeExchange adoption here,” he adds.

House swapping, while suddenly fashionable, is far from new. The concept dates to the 1950s, when enterprising American teachers on opposite coasts swapped homes for their holidays. Home-Link, the pioneering organisation, is now in its 73rd year. There are also unofficial ways of swapping houses like Facebook groups, but an official platform provides more security for your home. Over the years, what has changed is the scale

and the technology. What was once a niche for retirees or professors has become an option for families, couples, and digital nomads. With the rise of remote work, the ability to “live elsewhere” for a stretch—while still logging into Zoom—has only increased the appeal. Swaphouse, another platform to exchange homes, was launched post Covid by a couple based in Amsterdam, especially for those looking to work remotely. It has around 2,000 members globally, including in India. It’s a free platform and works like HomeExchange, except

that you sign up using your LinkedIn profile and the most important thing to emphasise is your Wi-Fi speed. Another platform, People Like Us, set up in 2018 by a couple in Sydney, is present in 120 countries, including India. They offer a 30-day free trial and then charge \$159 annually. Their site currently has around 15 houses from India.

Back in 2006, Diaz and Winslet’s swap seemed pure fantasy. In 2025, for Indian travellers, it is becoming a new reality. **BT**

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